

CAREER DEVELOPMENT PLAN TEMPLATE

Aligned with the Career Clarity Framework – Define Your Next Job Role

1. My 1 Sentence Why

Write ONE sentence completing the prompt below.
You cannot use the words: money, stability, or opportunity.

I am making a career move because ...

Why Bingo

Tick the motivations that match your why. Note which ones surprised you.

☐ Growth	☐ Impact	☐ Autonomy	☐ Recognition
☐ Purpose	☐ Flexibility	☐ Creativity	☐ Belonging

2. Rank Your Career Priorities

Rank 1–7 for each column (1 = most important).
Do both columns independently before comparing.

Factor	Current Role (Rank 1–7)	Ideal Next Role (Rank 1–7)	Gap (Difference)
Work (tasks I do day-to-day)			
Opportunities (growth & learning)			
Company (mission, reputation)			
Industry (sector I work in)			
Environment (culture, flexibility)			
Rewards & Recognition			
People (team, manager, peers)			

Top 3 priorities for my next role and why:

- 1. _____
- 2. _____
- 3. _____

3. Industry Exploration

List industries or sectors that interest you.

4. Interest and Experience Mapping

Write max 8 industries or roles in the boxes below. Place each one where it honestly belongs.

HIGH enthusiasm · HIGH experience Start here – these are your immediate targets.	HIGH enthusiasm · LOW experience Your 12-month ambition. Put a star here.

5. Generating Career Niches

Use the techniques below to generate potential career directions.

Combination Technique (combine multiple interests):
Example: Health + Technology → Digital Health
Your combinations:

Expansion Technique (expand one interest into multiple areas):

Logical Connectors (companies connected to previous employers):
Suppliers / Clients / Competitors / Partners:

Logical Pivot (changing industry, function, or both):

6. Define Your Target Career Direction

Write continuously for 4 minutes. No editing, no stopping. Answer all 3 questions in one flow.

Q1. When was the last time you over-delivered at work? What was it and why did you work so hard?

Q2. When were you last extremely excited about something you were working on? What was it?

Q3. If you didn't need money, which work role would you gladly continue doing for free?

7. Career Mapping – Target Companies

Use all 5 sources. Aim for 35–40 companies on your personal target list eventually.

Source	What to look for	Companies I found
Competitors of ex-company	Who competed with your last employer?	
Dream Employers	Companies you've always admired – even if they seem out of reach	
Job Postings	Companies posting roles in your target function right now	
Trend-following	Companies in growth sectors: AI, green tech, health, sustainability	
AI	Use AI to generate companies in your sub-niches	

8. Strategic Networking

List people who could help you learn more about your target roles.

Ex-colleagues: _____

Alumni / classmates: _____

Industry professionals: _____

LinkedIn contacts: _____

Who will you reach out to first?

9. Informational Interviews

Prepare questions to ask professionals in your target industry.

Example questions:

- What skills are most valuable in this role?
- Which companies are hiring in this space?
- Who else should I speak with?

Case study: A senior professional you've never spoken to replies on LinkedIn, they are happy to help and want a copy of your CV to refer you internally. What do you do and how do you make the most of this?

My response:

10. Career Action Plan

Define the next steps you will take.

Action 1: _____ Timeline: _____

Action 2: _____ Timeline: _____

Action 3: _____ Timeline: _____

11. Gaining Experience

Identify ways to build experience in your target direction.

Side projects: _____

Volunteering: _____

Freelance / consulting: _____

Courses / certifications: _____

Industry events / communities: _____

